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47 years

Empathy Map

(Case Study)

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PRINCIPLES OF DESIGN THINKING
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EMPATHY MAP IN DESIGN THINKING

What is an Empathy Map?

An Empathy Map is a simple Design Thinking tool used to understand what a user thinks, feels, says, does, hears and sees. It helps designers understand the user's real problems before creating a solution.

Six simple parts:

SAYS	THINKS
What the user says aloud.	What the user is thinking.
DOES	**FEELS**
What the user actually does.	The user's emotions.
SEES	**HEARS**
What the user observes.	What the user hears from others.

CASE STUDY: SMART COLLEGE BUS APP

Problem:

College students often wait for buses without knowing the exact arrival time. This creates stress, delays and sometimes extra travel costs.

Empathy Map Findings:

Area	Finding
User	College student who travels by bus
Main problem	Uncertain bus arrival time and overcrowding
Emotion	Stress, worry and frustration
Need	Simple and reliable bus information
Opportunity	Create an app showing live bus location, arrival time and crowd level

Solution:

Idea:

A Smart College Bus App that displays the bus location, estimated arrival time, route and crowd level. Students can quickly decide whether to wait, take another bus or choose another option.

Why the Empathy Map is Useful:

• Helps us understand the user before designing.

• Shows the user's real needs, feelings and problems.

• Helps convert problems into better design ideas.

• Makes the final solution more user-centered.

Summary:

Empathy → Understand the user → Find the problem → Create ideas → Test the solution.

Conclusion:

An empathy map helps designers stop guessing and start designing from the user's point of view.